



Delaware County Council Meeting January 24th 2023

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4KTNDwzl8Hc
Publication Date	2023-01-24T20:34:38Z
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Delaware County Council Meeting Summary

Meeting Date: January 2024

Body: Delaware County Council

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The meeting was called to order at [00:00:07](#) by presiding officer Mr. Spangler (referred to as Madam/Mr. President/Chair throughout the session, explicitly opening the January 2024 Delaware County Council meeting).
- **Attendance:**
 - **Present:** Mr. Flanagan, Mr. Hughes, Mr. Gantz, Mrs. Laster, Mr. Webb, Mr. Whitehead, Mrs. Piper, and Mr. Freeman.
 - **Absent:** None noted.
 - **Presiding Officer:** Mr. Spangler.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The council opened with the Pledge of Allegiance led by Bill ([00:00:12](#)) followed by a moment of silence to recognize the passing of Marta Moody, an important member of the Delaware County family ([00:00:31](#)).

- **Approval of Agenda:** The agenda was approved by voice vote following a motion by Eugene and a second by Dan (00:02:01).
- **Approval of Minutes:** Minutes of the January 2nd council meeting were approved via roll call vote (00:02:17).

4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:02:48 County General & Departmental Transfers (HR, Communications, Jail, Probation, Highway, Clerk, Treasurer):**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Pam (HR/Commissioners), Fred (Communications), and respective department heads.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The council reviewed multiple departmental transfers resulting in a net-zero financial change across various funds (County General, Communications, Jail, Other Adult User Fees, Highway, Clerk, and Treasurer). Discussions centered on employee repositioning, replacements, and routine internal reclassifications.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** All transfer packages received favorable recommendations from the finance committee and were approved unanimously via separate roll call votes.
- **00:14:53 Financial Appropriations - County General Clerk (Ordinance / Position Creation):**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Rick Spangler (Clerk) / Donna.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The Clerk requested a \$100 correction for Deputy Clerk and an additional \$37,000 appropriation to establish a new "First Deputy / Elections" position to manage increased election security, mandatory voting list maintenance (purging 8<U+2013>12% inactive voters), and absentee ballot processing. Extensive debate occurred regarding expanding government size versus the practical need to prepare for the upcoming demanding 2024 municipal/presidential election cycle.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved via roll call vote following a motion by Eugene and a second by Dan (00:15:13).
- **00:27:33 Financial Appropriations - Communications Fund (Part-Time & Supervisor Positions):**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Fred.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Request for \$15,000 (part-time) and \$9,080 (supervisor position reclassification), totaling \$24,080 in net appropriations (combined into total reporting of \$61,180 with prior items), offset by anticipated 911 funding increases from the city.

- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved via roll call vote following a motion by Ryan and a second by Eugene (00:27:55).
- **00:32:25 Financial Appropriations - Grant Funds & Capital Improvements:**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Various department heads.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Approvals for several external grant-funded appropriations and capital improvements, including:
 - Local Coordinating Council (Alcohol/Drug Abuse) grant (00:32:25).
 - CASA longevity and JCAT pilot project grants (00:34:46 & 00:35:35).
 - CASA/VOCA reimbursement grant (00:36:24).
 - DUI Grant Operation Pullover (00:39:46).
 - EMS Capital Improvements for emergency furnace replacements (\$8,876) (00:40:32).
 - SVO Fund supplies and tech (\$4,209 / \$12,000 total) (00:42:09).
 - Statewide 911 training/travel expense correction (\$20,000) (00:42:50).
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** All grant and capital appropriation items were approved separately by voice/roll call votes following favorable finance committee recommendations.
- **00:44:53 Annual Board & Committee Appointments:**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Council President.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The council reviewed applications and conducted roll-call nominations and votes for various community boards and commissions, transitioning to individual roll-call votes where multiple nominees stood:
 - **Alcohol Beverage Board:** Doug Hutchinson appointed (00:47:17).
 - **Animal Shelter Board:** Beth Neff appointed (00:49:57).
 - **Community Corrections:** Jessica Piper appointed (00:51:03).
 - **Daleville Economic Board:** Brent Cheatham appointed (00:52:06).
 - **EMA Advisory Board:** Clarified that the Council President serves ex-officio (00:53:29).
 - **Fair Board:** Rhiannon Reed appointed following general discussion regarding fresh perspectives on community boards (01:12:14).
 - **Housing Authority:** Slate A (current sitting members: Kira Childers, Lathy/Kira, Jason Lips) appointed (01:05:45).
 - **Redevelopment Commission:** Carrie Wiggerly (Democrat) and Rob kiesling (Republican) appointed (01:07:49 & 01:09:13).
 - **Tax Abatement Committee:** Ryan Ballard, Bill Hughes, and Josh Perkins appointed (01:13:29).
 - **Yorktown Economic Development Commission:** Dan Flanagan appointed (01:14:35).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** All appointments finalized by individual roll-call votes.

- **01:17:15 Approval of 2023 Encumbrances:**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Donna (Auditor).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Routine year-end encumbrances rolled into the first two months of the new year.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved via roll call vote on a motion by Dan and second by Eugene (**01:17:50**).
 - **01:34:04 Resolution 2023-005: Designation of Delaware County as a Vote Center County:**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Rick Spangler (Clerk).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Introduction and review of a boilerplate resolution required by the state election division to formalize Delaware County's status as a Vote Center County ahead of statutory deadlines. Commissioners had already unanimously approved the measure.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote following a motion by Eugene and second by Bill (**01:34:46**).
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5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- No residents signed up or spoke during the general open public comment period (**01:39:00**).
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6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - Sheriff Tony Skinner gave preliminary updates on jail metrics, meal costs, commissary reports, and announced upcoming federal inmate contract progress (**01:20:01**).
 - Coroner Gavin Green provided quarterly caseload and statistic reports (**01:22:57**).
 - Court Administrator Emily Anderson and Council Attorney addressed a lingering legal/audit question regarding voluntary judge stipend reallocations for court staff salaries, concluding that an explanatory attorney letter would satisfy State Board of accounts audit guidelines (**01:26:02**).
 - Council member Ryan expressed procedural grievances regarding informal council gatherings held outside of public notice, emphasizing future transparency (**01:36:17**).
 - Next meeting scheduled for Tuesday, February 28th at 9:00 a.m. (**01:39:32**).
 - **Adjournment:** The meeting was officially adjourned following a motion by Dan and a second by Eugene (**01:39:38**).
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